



TECHNOLOGY ZONE

SPECIAL TECHNOLOGY ZONE

Where Technology meets Scale

B-17 Islamabad · STZA-licensed Zone Developer · J7 Group

STZA NOTIFIED ZONE

PAKISTANI SCALE-UPS

WORK + LIVE ECOSYSTEM

B-17 ISLAMABAD

J7 GROUP

COMMERCIALISATION BRIEF · J7 GROUP

TECH7

STZA

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Largest Single-Building Technology Zone in Pakistan

A notified STZ with ready floors at scale, inside a 3.2M sq ft J7 destination.

1.1M

SQ FT NOTIFIED STZ

ACTIVE

ZONE DEVELOPER

700,000+

SQ FT NET LEASABLE

B-17

ISLAMABAD



THE PROPOSITION

Base to license under STZA, scale operations and export with confidence.

What We Genuinely Win On

Five advantages no competing zone in the capital region can match.

1	Ready floors at scale	A tenant needing 40,000 sq ft or several floors has no real alternative in this corridor. Competing zones offer land that needs building, or floor plates too small.
2	LEED Gold and carbon neutral	European and US procurement now imposes supplier sustainability criteria. A delivery centre in a certified carbon-neutral facility can answer that in an RFP.
3	Hotel and residential on site	Visiting client teams, auditors and engineering delegations stay in the building. Senior staff can live there. No competing zone offers either.
4	Airport and motorway access	Nearest STZ to the new Islamabad International Airport and the M-2. For any tenant whose clients or auditors fly in, this is the most cited preference.
5	A private developer	Decisions are commercial and fast. Institutional zones move at institutional speed. For a tenant with a lease expiring in four months, that decides the deal.

Technologies Eligible for License at Tech7

Categories preferably considered for a Zone Enterprise licence under the STZA Rules, 2021.

COMPUTING, DATA & AI

- AI and Machine Learning
- Big Data Analytics
- Quantum Computing
- Cloud Computing
- Internet of Things (IoT)
- Robo Advisory

ICT & ELECTRONICS

- ICTS
- IT and ITeS
- Semiconductors
- Electronics
- Smart Phones and Laptops
- Converging Technologies

ADVANCED TECH & MFG

- Natural Language Processing
- Augmented / Virtual Reality
- Robotics
- Wearables
- 3D-Printing
- Nanotech

FINTech & BLOCKCHAIN

- Fintech and Blockchain
- Distributed Ledger (DLT)
- Mobile Payment

A ZONE ENTERPRISE LICENCE IS WHAT CARRIES THE EXEMPTIONS – NOT THE FLOOR

Several industrial activities are named categories in their own right.

HEALTH & BIOSCIENCES

- Biotech and Genomics
- Biomedical Technology
- Medical Devices
- Telemedicine

ENERGY & AUTOMOTIVE

- Electric Vehicles
- Automobiles
- Sustainable and Renewable Energy
- Green Energy

EDUCATION & INSTITUTIONS

- Edtech
- Science and / or Technology Institution
- Technology Skill Development Centers

OTHER SPECIALISED SECTORS

- Agri-Tech
- Creative Industries
- Ecommerce
- Satellites
- Fine Chemicals
- New Materials
- Precise Instruments
- Environmental Technologies
- Tertiary Industries
- Other emerging technology areas

CAPITAL GOODS IMPORTED FOR A LICENSED ACTIVITY CARRY THE CUSTOMS, SALES TAX AND INCOME TAX EXEMPTION

Applicable STZA Incentives

For licensed Zone Enterprises. Current STZA guidance runs to 30 June 2035.

**30 JUN
2035**

CURRENT STZA
GUIDANCE
INCENTIVE ENDPOINT



Profit & gains tax

Exemption from profits and gains tax.



Alternate corporate tax

Exemption from alternate corporate tax.



Dividend / long-term gains

Specified VC investments in licensed entities may qualify.



Minimum tax

Exemption from minimum tax on turnover.



Import taxes & duties



Licence required

Space alone does not create incentives. The company needs its own ZE licence.

ELIGIBILITY

What it takes to qualify

Three conditions, then an evaluation on what the business contributes.

1

A registered entity

Incorporated with SECP, or registered with the relevant authority as prescribed under the STZA Act 2021.

2

Space allotted in a notified zone

Tech7 provides this. Allotment inside the zone precedes the Zone Enterprise licence application.

3

A licensed technology category

The business activity must sit within the categories under the STZA (Qualification and Approval) Rules 2021.

HOW APPLICATIONS ARE EVALUATED

R&D · local job creation · technology transfer · human capital development · export growth · import substitution

LICENCE BANDS

STARTUP

1-20 employees

SME

21-250 employees

LARGE ENTERPRISE

251-1,000 employees

ANCHOR ENTERPRISE

1,001+ employees

Exemptions commence from the date the licence is granted. They cannot be claimed retrospectively.

Three Routes into the Zone

The licence attaches to the entity and its activity, not to the building. Each route is structured differently.

01

A Pakistani technology company

Software houses, BPOs, capability centres, fintechs and data businesses license directly as a Zone Enterprise and take floors sized to headcount.

02

The technology arm of an industrial or corporate group

A group forms a separate company for its software, ERP and data operations, analytics, engineering design, R&D and back-office processing. That entity licenses as a Zone Enterprise and carries the exemptions, including duty-free import of its servers and equipment. STZA guidance expressly contemplates a group forming a new company to join a zone.

03

An international company using Pakistan as a launch pad

100% foreign ownership is permitted and profits and dividends are fully repatriable. A delivery, development or support base established here carries the same exemptions as a domestic licensee.

Built for Companies that earn in foreign currency

For an exporter, the forex account is worth more than the tax line. It is what closes the decision.

FX

SPECIAL FOREX ACCOUNTS

Active Zone Enterprises can access Special Forex Accounts.

100

NO FORCED CONVERSION

Export earnings held in dollars, without mandatory conversion to rupees.



REPATRIABLE RETURNS

STZA promotes fully repatriable profits and dividends.

CF

CAPITAL FLOW

Forex-account structures designed to ease capital movement.

GL

GLOBAL OPERATIONS

Export receipts and payments through compliant banking.



LOCAL EXECUTION

Tech7 coordinates company, banking, STZA and workspace.

Technology Verticals

Where the demand already exists..

Vertical	Why they take space	Representative companies
IT services & software	Lease expiry and headcount growth. Largest volume of the domestic pipeline	Systems Limited, NETSOL Technologies
BPO & contact centres	Client audits demand certified facilities, uptime and continuity	TRG Pakistan, Ibex
Global capability centres	Foreign parent imposes facility and ESG standards	Contour Software, 10Pearls
Fintech & digital finance	Fastest-growing enterprise employer, and a segment that clusters	JazzCash, SadaPay
E-commerce & logistics tech	Warehousing of data and operations rather than goods	Daraz, Trax
Healthtech & telemedicine	Telemedicine is a licensed category in its own right	Sehat Kahani, oladoc
Edtech & skill development	Skill development institutions license directly	Sabaq, Taleemabad

34,420 IT AND ITeS COMPANIES REGISTERED WITH SECP · AROUND 350 HOUSED IN FORMAL ZONES

Industrial and Enterprise Verticals

Groups outside the technology sector qualify through their technology and shared-services arm.

Vertical	What sits inside the zone	Representative companies
Banking & financial services	Digital banking platforms, core systems, data and analytics units	HBL, Meezan Bank
Telecom & connectivity	Network operations, digital products, data centre and cloud units	Jazz, PTCL
Energy, cleantech & renewables	A licensed category directly. Monitoring, control and analytics platforms	Reon Energy, Shams Power
Manufacturing & industrials	ERP and shared services, engineering design, R&D, automation	Group technology subsidiaries
Automotive, EV & electronics	EV systems and electronics are licensed categories in their own right	Sazgar Engineering, Jolta
Agritech & food systems	Agritech is a licensed category. Data platforms and supply-chain systems	Tazah, Farmdar
AI, compute & data services	Domestic hosting under data-residency rules. Duty-free GPUs and servers	Data centre and cloud operators

AN ESTIMATED USD 700-800 M A YEAR IS SPENT RENTING FOREIGN COMPUTING POWER

How the market divides

Seven segments, each with a different buyer, a different cycle and a different decision.

BPO & CONTACT CENTRES

Largest area per decision. Audits the facility, uptime and certification before anything else.

DOMESTIC IT SCALE-UPS

The volume of the pipeline. Move on lease expiry and headcount pressure.

OPC / SMC MICRO-SUITES

An individual decision made in days. Highest rate per sq ft in the building.

GLOBAL CAPABILITY CENTRES

A foreign parent imposes facility and ESG standards. Usually multi-city already.

AI, COMPUTE & DATA

Capital-goods exemption is worth more than rent. Power and cooling are the limits.

CHINESE TECH & HARDWARE

Duty-free capital-goods import is decisive. The on-site hotel matters more than expected.

GULF DELIVERY CENTRES

Time zone and talent cost. Reached through diaspora and trade channels.

SEQUENCE MATTERS MORE THAN EFFORT – THE CYCLES ARE NOT THE SAME LENGTH

Four ways to take space at Tech7

Pakistani companies buy space differently by size and stage. Tech7 is priced and packaged for each.

01

ENTERPRISE FLOORS

Pakistani BPOs, software houses and GCCs needing whole floors, operating this year.

02

OPC / SMC SUBSCRIPTION

Incorporation, ZE licence, registered address and a desk sold as one annual subscription.

03

AI & DATA CLUSTER

High-density compute configured against verified power, cooling and network capacity.

04

INTERNATIONAL LANDING PAD

A Pakistan base for Chinese, Gulf and international technology companies.

MORE THAN SPACE – A COMPLETE OPERATING PLATFORM

OPC / SMC subscription

Sell the licence and the compliance. Space becomes the delivery mechanism.

~1 m

freelancers nationally

0.04%

capture equals 400 units

100,000

sq ft absorbed

~PKR 400

per sq ft, against a blended 224

What the buyer is actually paying for, in the order they value it

A special foreign currency account

No forced conversion of dollar earnings. For someone billing USD 40,000 to 100,000 a year, the conversion spread is the largest recurring cost in the business. This closes the sale, not the tax line.

A corporate identity and an acceptable invoice

What stops most Pakistani freelancers winning enterprise contracts is that they cannot invoice as a company from a registered address. This converts a freelancer into a vendor.

Exemption on profits and gains to June 2035

Against 0.25% under PSEB, confirmed only to June 2029. The value of this rises every year as that deadline approaches.

Why it matters beyond its revenue

It fills the lower floors early, and visible occupancy is what larger tenants look for before committing. An empty zone is hard to lease. A busy one leases itself.

What actually makes a company move

Tax opens the conversation. It almost never closes one.

1

Lease expiry

The highest-conversion signal by far. A company approached nine to twelve months before expiry is in the market. The same company a month after renewal is not.

2

Headcount outgrowing premises

A firm that has doubled staff in two years is already uncomfortable. Growth rate is public. NETSOL at 16.7% year on year is exactly the pattern.

3

A failed client audit

ISO, SOC 2 and enterprise audits impose facility and continuity requirements that converted houses cannot meet. A failed audit forces a move on a short timeline.

4

Power or connectivity failure

One serious outage during a client delivery window will move a BPO. Guaranteed uptime and redundant fibre are what they are actually buying.

5

A new international contract

Winning a large Western client often requires demonstrable facility standards, where LEED Gold stops being a brochure line and becomes a procurement requirement.

6

Talent attrition

Where staff leave for better-premised competitors, the cost of moving is smaller than the cost of rehiring. Amenity and residential are retention arguments.

THE PIPELINE MUST CARRY LEASE EXPIRY, HEADCOUNT AND CERTIFICATION STATUS – NOT JUST NAME AND SIZE

Infrastructure aligned to enterprise requirements

Power, connectivity, security and compute configured to the client requirement.



READY OFFICE

Client-facing office and collaboration space for a faster launch.



POWER RESILIENCE

Scalable power and backup configured to verified enterprise load.



CONNECTIVITY

Multi-carrier fibre and secure private-network solutions.



SECURITY

Controlled access, tenant segregation, cybersecurity and monitoring.



AI / DATA

High-density compute assessed against power, cooling and network.

Building Systems before Offer

A promise the building cannot meet is worse than no promise. Each item is closed and evidenced, not asserted.

MEP

Mechanical, electrical and plumbing signed off per floor. HVAC capacity, distribution and commissioning recorded floor by floor.

POWER & BACKUP

Grid supply, generator backup, UPS provision and riser capacity confirmed, and expressed as a contractual uptime standard.

INTERNET & REDUNDANCY

Multi-carrier fibre on physically diverse routes. Redundancy proven before BPO and contact-centre floors are quoted.

SOVEREIGN INTERNET & HOSTING

Domestic routing and in-country hosting capability for tenants carrying data-residency obligations.

LOAD-BEARING CAPACITY

Structural floor loading confirmed per slab for server racks, battery rooms and dense storage. This decides which floors can take compute.

DATA CENTRE FEASIBILITY

Cooling, power density, fire suppression, containment and cable pathways assessed against a defined rack profile.

Tenant Assurance Before Floor is offered

What a client's assessor will ask to see on the day they audit the building.

SECURITY & ACCESS CONTROL

Controlled access, tenant segregation, CCTV coverage, visitor management and manned security, with a retained audit trail.

CERTIFICATION PATHWAY

ISO 27001 and SOC 2 readiness scoped, costed and under way. This is what a BPO or financial-services client audits before signing.

FIRE & LIFE SAFETY

Detection, suppression, compartmentation, egress and drill records, evidenced per floor rather than for the building as a whole.

FIT-OUT CONDITION

Ready, warm shell or grey shell recorded per floor, with the cost and lead time to bring each to occupation.

SERVICE STANDARD

Written SLA covering uptime, response times, escalation and maintenance windows. A prospect asks for this in the first meeting.

COMMISSIONING & HANDOVER

Systems tested under load, snagging closed and handover documentation issued before the floor is released.

TALLEST
/IN CITIES

J7 EMPORIUM

WORK + LIVE ECOSYSTEM

Technology, retail, hospitality, wellness and serviced living in one destination.

OFFICE

Technology-zone workspace

HOTEL

Delegations & executive stays

RETAIL

Food, banking & services

WELLNESS

Gym, club & recreation

PARKING

Large integrated parking

LIVING

Residential & serviced living

**A work-live ecosystem reduces friction for teams,
executives and delegations.**

Islamabad as Base

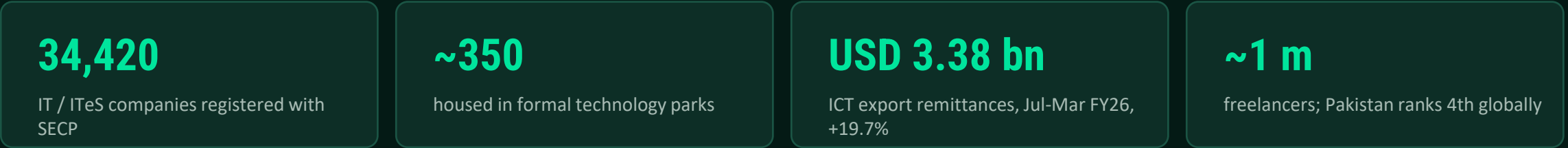
Where Pakistani firms already sell, and where a certified facility opens the next contract.



Where certified premises stop being overhead and start winning contracts.

The Demand

Thirty-four thousand registered technology companies against fewer than four hundred inside formal zones.



The gap	Roughly one per cent of the market has moved into a notified zone. For a company weighing the decision, that means the fiscal advantage is still largely uncontested.
AI and compute	Pakistan spends an estimated USD 700-800 m a year renting foreign computing power, while the National Data Governance Policy 2026 requires sensitive data to be hosted domestically. GPUs and servers are capital goods, so a zone license removes duty and sales tax on import.
Digital financial services	The fastest-growing enterprise employer in the country, and a segment that clusters. Where one goes, the supply chain follows.

COMPETITIVE POSITION

Where Tech7 Sits

The capital region is the most contested STZ market in Pakistan.

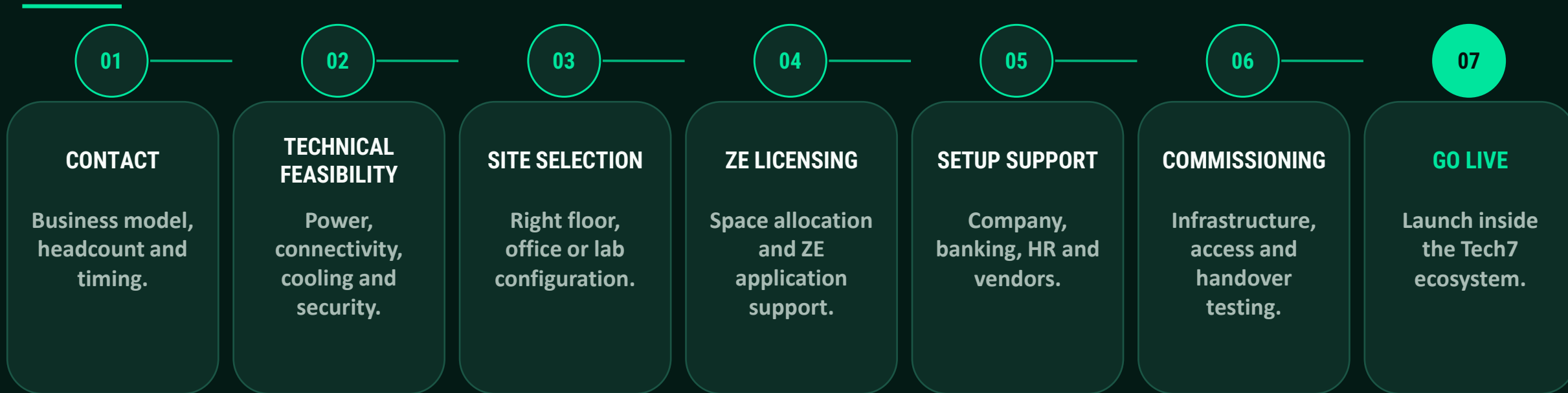
Zone	Location	Scale / position	What they win on
NUST STZ	Islamabad	University-anchored	Talent pipeline, academic brand, research partnerships
Capital Smart TZ	Rawalpindi	Rs 100 bn potential	Masterplanned city, land scale, long-horizon investors
NASTP Alpha	Rawalpindi	Aerospace and cyber	Government and defence contracts, institutional backing
Mindbridge	Lahore	360,000 sq ft, Rs 5 bn	Two decades of BPO history and a full certification stack
NASTP Silicon Valley	Karachi	Mixed technology	Karachi market, cybersecurity and aerospace cluster
TECH7	Islamabad B-17	~1 m sq ft, Rs 5-6 bn	Ready floors at scale, LEED Gold, hotel and residential, airport access

EVERY NOTIFIED ZONE OFFERS THE SAME STATUTORY PACKAGE – THE DIFFERENCE IS THE BUILDING AND THE SERVICE

32 Zones are now notified nationally, housing over 15,000 technology professionals. We compete on the building and on service.

Controlled Onboarding Pathway

One pathway aligns commercial, technical and regulatory workstreams.



FROM REQUIREMENT TO OPERATING TENANT

WHY PAKISTANI TECHNOLOGY COMPANIES CHOOSE TECH7

STZA Fiscal & forex framework

Applicable incentives and Special Forex Account pathway.

FAST Ready floors at scale

Whole floors available now. No construction wait, no split premises.

OPS Enterprise delivery model

Technical requirements aligned before handover.

J7 Integrated ecosystem

Work, hospitality, retail, wellness and living in one place.

LOCAL Local execution partner

On-ground coordination across partners and vendors.

REG Regional export position

Islamabad base for entry and regional service delivery.

Certified premises, ready floors and a licensing route – open to Pakistani companies and to international firms using Tech7 as their Pakistan launch pad.



TECHNOLOGY ZONE

BUILD YOUR NEXT OPERATING BASE AT TECH7

Tell us the requirement. Tech7 aligns the floor, the infrastructure and the STZA licence.

- ✓ Review the floor options for your headcount
- ✓ Visit Tech7 and review the environment
- ✓ Define power, network and security needs
- ✓ Evaluate your STZA Zone Enterprise pathway

COMMERCIALIZATION DESK

Omar Khattak

Head, Tech7 Special Technology Zone

J7 Group · B-17 Islamabad